

Device Use Best Practices -- Guided Notes ANSWER KEY

Unit tp-6.11 | CompTIA Network+ N10-009 Obj. FC0-U71 6.2 | N10-008 FC0-U71 6.2

For instructor use / distribute after students complete the notes.

Question 1

Acceptable Use Policies (AUPs) define what employees may and may not do with company devices and networks. They are signed at _____ and set legal and disciplinary precedent for violations. Key AUP topics include: personal use of company _____, prohibited _____ and websites, handling of _____ data, and reporting obligations.

Answer: Onboarding; devices; software; sensitive.

Question 2

Company devices should only have _____ -approved software installed. Unauthorized software (shadow IT) may contain _____, create unpatched _____ attack surfaces, and circumvent _____ controls. Employees should not use personal _____ accounts or cloud storage to store company data.

Answer: IT (approved); malware; vendor; security; email/cloud.

Question 3

USB drives are a _____ security risk. They can introduce _____ (if plugged in from an untrusted source) and exfiltrate _____ (if used to copy sensitive files). Organizations can mitigate USB risk by: disabling _____ ports in BIOS or via policy, using _____ that only allow company-issued drives, or deploying DLP to block sensitive file copies.

Answer: Physical; malware; data; USB; whitelisting (device control software).

Question 4

Screen _____ should lock the device after a short period of inactivity (5-15 minutes). Devices should require a _____ or biometric to unlock. When leaving a workstation even briefly, users should manually _____ the screen (Windows: Win+L, macOS: Ctrl+Cmd+Q). _____ surfing -- reading someone's screen in public -- is a real physical security threat.

Answer: Lock; password/PIN; lock; shoulder.

Question 5

Remote work introduces additional risks including use of _____ Wi-Fi networks, _____ routers with default passwords, and family members using company devices. Organizations should require _____ (VPN) use when working off-site and prohibit _____ sharing of company devices with family members.

Answer: Public; home; VPN; device.

Question 6

Software updates and patches should be applied _____ because most malware exploits _____ vulnerabilities (known flaws with available fixes). Enabling _____ updates for OS and major applications removes the human delay. _____ reboots required to complete patches should be performed promptly even if inconvenient.

Answer: Promptly; known; automatic; pending.

Question 7

When a device is _____ for disposal, repurposing, or return, its data must be securely wiped. Simply _____ files does not remove them -- the data can be recovered with forensic tools. Secure deletion methods include _____ -pass overwrites, _____ (destroying the drive physically), and _____ (if the drive was fully encrypted, deleting the key renders all data unrecoverable).

Answer: Decommissioned; deleting; multi; shredding/degaussing; crypto-erasure.

Question 8 -- Real World Application

REAL WORLD: An employee working from home connects their company laptop to the public Wi-Fi at a local coffee shop to finish a report. They email the report as a Word attachment to their personal Gmail because they cannot access the company file share from outside the office. Identify two security policy violations in this scenario and explain the risk each creates.

Answer: Violation 1 -- Using public Wi-Fi without a VPN: public Wi-Fi is unencrypted and untrusted. An attacker on the same network can perform a man-in-the-middle attack, intercepting unencrypted traffic including email credentials, session tokens, and any unencrypted data transmitted. The AUP should require VPN use on any non-corporate network. The VPN creates an encrypted tunnel from the laptop to the company network, preventing eavesdropping. Violation 2 -- Sending company data to personal email (Gmail): corporate data sent to a personal email account is outside the company's control. Gmail is not covered by the company's DLP policies, retention rules, or security monitoring. If the employee's Gmail account is compromised (password reuse, phishing), attackers gain access to the report. Additionally, this creates a data governance problem -- the company cannot audit, retrieve, or delete data stored in personal accounts. The fix is cloud-accessible company file storage (SharePoint, OneDrive, Google Workspace) so employees can work remotely without resorting to personal email.